

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A6: Controlled Imitation

Preserve a declared syntactic architecture while changing the proposition, then detect and revise English-driven calques

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	EL-A5 and the ability to document a model's exact structure
Next	EL-A7, Guided Composition

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A6. Controlled imitation

Composition becomes reliable when constraints are changed one at a time. Imitation here means preserving an observable grammatical or rhetorical frame, not pretending to manufacture an approved liturgical text.

A **model** is the attested sentence selected as evidence. A **frame** is the model's reusable architecture after particular vocabulary has been abstracted; it includes required constructions and their relations, not just a sequence of blank spaces. A **constraint** states what a draft must preserve, change, include, or exclude. A **transformation** is one deliberate change made under those constraints.

On completing this unit, you can:

- transform a model while preserving its syntax;
- select vocabulary from attested constructions;
- diagnose English calques; and
- revise for agreement, government, sequence, and cohesion.

1.1 The imitation ladder

1. **Substitution:** replace one noun family, adjusting every agreeing or governing form. Substitution changes a selected constituent while retaining its syntactic role.
2. **Expansion:** add one participial, relative, or prepositional modifier without changing the main architecture. Expansion increases structure while leaving the original dependency intact.
3. **Compression:** replace a subordinate clause with a participle or ablative absolute where idiomatic. Compression expresses an existing relation with fewer finite clauses; it must not erase an essential logical relation.
4. **Polarity/person:** change affirmative to negative, singular to plural, or third person to first person while preserving the intended proposition and adjusting every dependent form.
5. **Semantic transfer:** retain the model's syntax and rhetorical sequence but replace its proposition, so that the new content is not a paraphrase of the model.

Worked example: a collect frame

Worked passage ID: W.IV.7; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Model: *Deus, qui hodierna die corda fidelium Sancti Spiritus illustratione docuisti: da nobis in eodem Spiritu recta sapere; et de eius semper consolatione gaudere.*

Frame:

Deus, qui + past divine act + : *da nobis* + two coordinated present infinitives, each with its complement.

Before substituting content, parse *corda*, *fidelium*, *illustratione*, *docuisti*, *nobis*, *recta*, and both infinitives. A successful imitation preserves the frame and attested constructions; it does not merely translate an English prayer word for word.

1.2 The calque audit

A **calque** is an expression reproduced piece by piece from another language. A calque may become established usage; the problem in this audit is an **unidiomatic calque**, whose resulting choices or construction lack support in the target register. Similarity to English is evidence for checking, not proof of error. **Cohesion** is the set of explicit links—reference, connectors, repetition, and ordered relations—that makes successive sentences function as one discourse.

For every draft, circle English-driven choices and ask:

- Does the Latin verb govern this case or construction?
- Is the abstract noun needed, or would Latin prefer a verb/adjective?
- Has English word order hidden agreement or produced ambiguity?
- Is the tense chosen for Latin aspect and sequence, not English form?
- Can an attested ecclesiastical parallel defend the phrase?

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The imitation ladder — transfer practice

Connection. Increasing freedom should change one controlled dimension at a time so the learner can locate a failure.

Transfer task. Starting from the lesson model, list its invariant clause slots. Draft three project-composed stages: lexical substitution, changed subject/object with full cascade, then changed proposition with the same architecture.

Retrieval check. Circle the first stage at which a governing construction changes.

1.2 The calque audit — transfer practice

Connection. A calque diagnosis names the English-driven construction and replaces it from a checked Latin pattern.

Transfer task. For the completed imitation, make three columns: suspect phrase, why English structure drove it, and revised Latin with model or grammar support.

Retrieval check. Name one revision that is stylistic and one required by government.

1.3 Worked invariant-and-change ledger — transfer practice

Connection. A visible ledger separates legitimate imitation from disguised copying.

Transfer task. Annotate one finished draft with S for preserved structure, P for changed proposition, M for morphological cascade, and B for borrowed phrase recorded in the source ledger.

Retrieval check. Explain why an unchanged long phrase requires stronger documentation than an unchanged clause type.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A6 worksheet family: controlled imitation

Worksheet IV.23 — Collect-frame imitation

Worksheet ID: IV.23

Focus: Preserve architecture, not vocabulary.

Use: Use the Pentecost model in Volume IV.

1. Identify the address and relative ground in *Deus, qui...docuisti*.

2. Identify the main petition and its recipient.

3. Identify the two requested acts.

4. Using *Deus, qui populum tuum misericordia liberavisti*, begin an imitation.

5. Complete it with *da nobis...* and two coordinated infinitives.

Worksheet IV.24 — Calque audit

Worksheet ID: IV.24

Focus: Revise English-driven Latin.

Use: Use on a draft, then on these samples.

1. Revise *facere sensum* intended as English “make sense.”

2. Revise *dependeo in Deo* for “I depend on God.”

3. Revise *oro pro quod veniat*.

4. Revise *Deus vult nos esse sanctus*.

5. Audit five phrases in your own draft and document an attested replacement or defense.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Write a clearly labeled exercise composition that preserves a documented model architecture while changing content, and defend every agreement, government, connective, and idiomatic revision without presenting the result as received text.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-A7, Guided Composition.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.21 and IV.22 remain optional agreement-cascade and expansion/compression remediation.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The imitation ladder — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing sequence labels every sentence project-composed, preserves the stated invariants at each stage, and marks all agreement/reference changes. If government changes unintentionally, the learner returns to the prior stage.

The calque audit — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The required revision must cite a case, complement, or clause construction; the stylistic revision may improve order or cohesion while preserving grammar. A bare claim that the revision “sounds better” does not pass.

Worked invariant-and-change ledger — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model records borrowed wording and its source, while structural labels describe abstract syntax. Unacknowledged extended wording is copying; a shared clause architecture is the declared object of imitation.

CHAPTER 2

A6 worksheet family: controlled imitation**Solution IV.23 — Collect-frame imitation**

Worksheet ID: IV.23

Focus: Preserve architecture, not vocabulary.

Use: Use the Pentecost model in Volume IV.

1. Identify the address and relative ground in *Deus, qui...docuisti*.
Answer / model: *Deus* vocative address; *qui* nominative relative subject referring to God, with perfect *docuisti* and its objects/means.
2. Identify the main petition and its recipient.
Answer / model: *da* imperative; *nobis* dative recipient/reference.
3. Identify the two requested acts.
Answer / model: Present active infinitives *sapere* and *gaudere*, coordinated and dependent on *da*.
4. Using *Deus, qui populum tuum misericordia liberavisti*, begin an imitation.
Answer / model: The supplied opening is already sound: vocative + relative clause, *populum tuum* object, *misericordia* ablative means, *liberavisti* perfect active.
5. Complete it with *da nobis...* and two coordinated infinitives.
Answer / model: Model: *Deus, qui populum tuum misericordia liberavisti: da nobis mandata tua diligere et in via tua perseverare*. Exercise composition, not a liturgical text.

Solution IV.24 — Calque audit

Worksheet ID: IV.24

Focus: Revise English-driven Latin.

Use: Use on a draft, then on these samples.

1. Revise *facere sensum* intended as English “make sense.”

Answer / model: Use an idiomatic proposition such as *intellegi potest* (it can be understood) or *rationi consentaneum est*, depending on intended sense; do not preserve the English collocation.

2. Revise *dependeo in Deo* for “I depend on God.”

Answer / model: Model: *a Deo pendeo* (with *ab + abl.*) or an attested ecclesiastical alternative fitting context.

3. Revise *oro pro quod veniat*.

Answer / model: Model: *oro ut veniat* for “I pray that he may come”; *pro* cannot introduce that content clause.

4. Revise *Deus vult nos esse sanctus*.

Answer / model: *Deus vult nos esse sanctos*; *nos* accusative subject of infinitive, *sanctos* predicate accusative agreeing.

5. Audit five phrases in your own draft and document an attested replacement or defense.

Answer / model: Answers vary; each decision needs the governing construction and a grammar, dictionary, or corpus reference.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A6, *Controlled Imitation*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. Every new Latin sentence in this packet's transfer practice is project-composed instructional material, not a liturgical prayer or received ecclesiastical text.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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